

Reading a viz → **Build manually** → Build with AI → Write interpretation → AI interpretation → Spot disruption

Create your first visualization

Activity · Visualizations & Interpretation · ~15 min

BEFORE YOU START

- ☐ You're signed in and looking at your country's project
- ☐ You're in the **Visualizations** tab
- ☐ You have a folder of your own (or you can use the shared one)

What you'll do

Create your first chart using the built-in builder: pick a **metric**, choose a **ready-made chart**, and it's saved to the project. You'll click through the builder yourself; the next activity does the same with the AI Assistant.

1 Open the visualization builder

In the Visualizations tab, click **+ Create visualization**. A three-step builder opens: **Metric** → **Presets** → **Configure**.

+ Create visualization

2 Pick a metric

Metrics are grouped by module on the left (M1. Data quality, M3. Service utilization, M4. Coverage...). A metric is **what is measured** — e.g. *Number of services reported, Actual vs expected service volume, Coverage*.

For a service-volume trend, open **M3. Service utilization** and pick a metric such as **Number of services reported**. Click **Next**.

3 Choose a ready-made chart

You'll see a grid of **presets** — ready-made charts. Choose **Service volume over time (monthly)** — a line chart of monthly volume by indicator. Click **Create**.

Your chart is created and appears in the **Visualizations** list. Use the **By folder** view to drop it into your folder.

The other presets give quarterly or annual **bar** charts. **Custom → Configure manually** lets you choose the chart type (table, time series, bar, map) and how to break the data down — see the next section.

Filter vs disaggregate — what's the difference?

These two words come up a lot. They are not the same:

- **Filter = show less.** Narrow the chart to a slice and hide the rest — e.g. *only ANC1, only Northern region, only the last 12 months*. Like a spotlight: you keep one thing, the rest disappears.
- **Disaggregate = break it down.** Split one total into its parts so you can compare them — e.g. *one line per indicator, or one bar per district*. Nothing is hidden; the total is shown as its pieces.

FILTER = take data out

Before — every indicator

Indicator	Value
ANC1	1,200
ANC4	800
BCG	950
Penta	600

filter to
ANC1

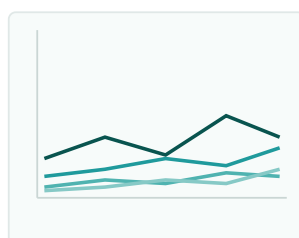
After — only ANC1

Indicator	Value
ANC1	1,200
ANC4	800
BCG	950
Penta	600

Keep the slice you want.

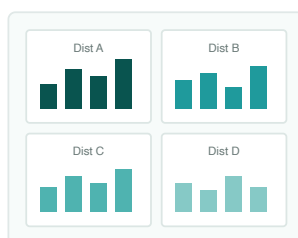
Everything else is removed —
like a spotlight: one lit, rest dark.

DISAGGREGATE “ANC1 by district” — four ways to display the parts



Lines

one line per district



Grid

a mini chart for each

District	Visits
Dist A	900
Dist B	850
Dist C	1,000
Dist D	800

Rows

one row per district

Dist A	Dist B	Dist C	Dist D
900	850	1,000	800

Columns

one column per district

Example. Start with *total ANC1 visits, nationally*. **Filter** to "Northern region" → you now see only Northern's ANC1, the rest removed. **Disaggregate** "by district" → the same total split into one bar (or line) per district.

Where you do this when you edit a viz

Open a saved visualization — the controls live in the **left panel**, and you'll often need to **scroll down** to find them (this is where people get lost). Two sections do the work:

- **Filter (subset)** — narrow the data: set the time period, or untick indicators to keep only the one(s) you want. This is how you *take data out*.
- **Display (disaggregate)** — choose **how the parts are shown**. The dropdown gives four options:
 - **Lines** — one line per part, all on the same chart
 - **Grid** — a separate little chart for each part, side by side
 - **Rows** — one table row per part
 - **Columns** — one table column per part

Data	Presentation	Text
Metric Actual vs expected service volume		
Presentation type Timeseries		
Filter (subset) ☐ Data values ☒ Time period ☒ Last N months ☐ From specific month to present ☐ Last N full calendar years ☐ Last N full calendar quarters ☐ Custom Number of months = 12 ☒ Indicator ANC1 ANC4 BCG DELIVERY OPD PENTA1 PENTA3 PNC1_MOTHER PNC1_NEWBORN		
Display (disaggregate) ☒ Data values (Required for this visualization) Lines		

Careful when you use both. Filtering and disaggregating work together — but don't filter away the very thing you're breaking down. If you break down **by district** but filter to **one district**, you'll see just that one, with nothing to compare. Simple rule: **filter the things you don't need; disaggregate the one you want to compare.**

Try a few options

Repeat with a different metric or preset — a coverage metric under **M4**, or the quarterly-change bar chart — to see how each reads.

Tip: Line charts (*Service volume over time*) are best for trends over time. Bar charts (*quarterly / annual change*) are better for comparing periods or places. The reference handout *How to read a FASTR visualization* goes deeper.

Check yourself

You should now have:

- At least one chart created and visible in your **Visualizations** list
- The path in muscle memory: **+ Create visualization → Metric → Presets → Create**
- A sense of which presets suit trends vs comparisons

What's next

The next activity does the same thing using the AI Assistant — typing a request in plain language instead of clicking through the builder. Same end result, different path.

 **Verify in your current UI:** labels (*+ Create visualization, Create*) may differ slightly. The **Metric → Presets → Create** path is the key structure.